

# Zongxia Li

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College Park, MD

Ph.D. candidate in computer science researching self-evolving agents, multimodal post-training, and human-AI collaboration.

## EDUCATION

**University of Maryland, College Park**

Expected June 2027

*Ph.D. in Computer Science*

*College Park, MD*

**University of Maryland, College Park**

May 2022

*B.S. in Computer Science and B.S. in Mathematics*

*College Park, MD*

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

**CLIP Lab, University of Maryland**

Sep 2022 – Present

*Graduate Research Assistant, advised by Jordan Boyd-Graber and Lichao Sun*

*College Park, MD*

- Research self-evolving agents, multimodal post-training, and human-AI collaboration, long-horizon tasks.
- First-author or co-first-author on projects including Long-Horizon-Terminal-Bench, MM-Zero, Self-Rewarding VLM, VideoHallu, and ComfyClaw.
- Published work spanning ICLR, CVPR, NeurIPS, ACL, and EMNLP.

**LLM Frontier Lab**

May 2026 – Aug 2026

*Research Scientist Intern, mentored by Yucheng Shi*

*Bellevue, WA*

- Work on building and synthesizing agentic long-horizon tasks such as terminal tasks, coding tasks.
- Work on self-improving agents from generating data from its own on long-horizon tasks.

**Tencent AI Lab**

May 2025 – Aug 2025

*Research Scientist Intern, mentored by Wenhao Yu*

*Bellevue, WA*

- Worked on self-evolving large language models and vision-language models using reinforcement learning and self-rewarding objectives.
- Studied methods for grounding multimodal models in visual understanding and reasoning.

**Adobe, Document Intelligence Lab**

May 2024 – Aug 2024

*Research Assistant Intern, mentored by Ani Nenkova*

*College Park, MD*

- Studied judge-ensemble methods for long-form text generation evaluation to improve agreement with expert human judgments.
- Compared LLM-based evaluators with crowdsourced annotations for reliable automatic evaluation.

**National Institute of Technology**

May 2023 – May 2024

*Graduate Research Assistant, mentored by Juan Fung*

*College Park, MD*

- Developed machine learning methods for content analysis and interactive data exploration.
- Ran ablation studies to understand how users learn from and navigate large document collections.

## SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

\* equal contribution. Full publication list available on [Google Scholar](#).

1. **Zongxia Li\***, Zhongzhi Li\*, Yucheng Shi\*, Ruhan Wang, Junyao Yang, et al. **Long-Horizon-Terminal-Bench: Testing the Limits of Agents on Long-Horizon Terminal Tasks with Dense Reward-Based Grading**. Preprint, 2026.
2. Ruhan Wang, Yucheng Shi, **Zongxia Li**, Zhongzhi Li, Yue Yu, et al. **Harness Handbook: Making Evolving Agent Harnesses Readable, Navigable, and Editable**. Preprint, 2026.
3. **Zongxia Li\***, Dawei Liu\*, Jingxi Chen, Xiyang Wu, Lichao Sun, et al. **An Agentic Harness for Skill-Evolving Image Generation Workflows**. Preprint, 2026.
4. **Zongxia Li\***, Wenhao Yu\*, Chengsong Huang, Rui Liu, Zhenwen Liang, et al. **Self-Rewarding Vision-Language Model via Reasoning Decomposition**. ICLR, 2026.
5. **Zongxia Li\***, Hongyang Du\*, Chengsong Huang\*, Xiyang Wu, Lantao Yu, et al. **MM-Zero: Self-Evolving Multi-Model Vision Language Models From Zero Data**. Preprint, 2026.

6. Dawei Liu\*, **Zongxia Li\***, Hongyang Du, Xiyang Wu, Lichao Sun. **Graph-of-Skills: Dependency-Aware Structural Retrieval for Massive Agent Skills**. Preprint, 2026.
7. Xiyang Wu, **Zongxia Li**, Guangyao Shi, Alexander Duffy, Tyler Marques, et al. **Co-Evolving LLM Decision and Skill Bank Agents for Long-Horizon Tasks**. Preprint, 2026.
8. Jingxi Chen\*, **Zongxia Li\***, Zhichao Liu, Guangyao Shi, Xiyang Wu, et al. **First Frame Is the Place to Go for Video Content Customization**. CVPR, 2026.
9. **Zongxia Li\***, Xiyang Wu\*, Yubin Qin, Hongyang Du, Guangyao Shi, et al. **VideoHallu: Evaluating and Mitigating Multi-modal Hallucinations for Synthetic Videos**. NeurIPS, 2025.
10. **Zongxia Li**, Lorena Calvo-Bartolome, et al. **Large Language Models Struggle to Describe the Haystack without Human Help: Human-in-the-loop Evaluation of LLMs**. ACL, 2025.

## SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE PROJECTS

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- **Large Vision-Language Models: A Survey & Benchmark Collection** – Curated repository of VLM benchmarks, RL alignment methods, and applications.
- **Dr. Claw: Your AI Research Assistant** – AI research assistant platform for agentic research workflows.

## SKILLS

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**Research:** Vision-language models, multimodal reasoning, reinforcement learning, post-training, agent systems, human-AI collaboration, evaluation  
**Languages:** Python, C, R, Java, JavaScript  
**Frameworks/Tools:** PyTorch, SQLite, Git, HTML/CSS, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X

## AWARDS

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- **Lambda Labs Research Compute Grant**, 2025
- **NIST Fellowship Award**